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# Introduction

Marks & Spencer is a leading retailer in the UK, serving customers in the fields of clothing, food, homeware and digital retail. GreenLife Living 2026 is a proposed customer engagement campaign to boost sustainable engagement in the assignment scenario. New to the market of environmentally-friendly household goods, sustainable clothing and packaging that can be recycled (P. Sathish, Sashikanth Reddy Avula and Channabasava, 2026). It has carbon-neutral shipping and an AI-powered mobile shopping assistant that suggests items based on their likes, dislikes and shopping data.

As a result of environmental issues, digital convenience and pressure on household spending are changing UK customer expectations. Customers have come to value transparency with respect to sustainability evidence, individualised interaction and a uniform experience throughout outlets, online and on mobile devices. However, high prices can decrease trust, as can uncorroborated environmental claims.

The marketing function, cross-functional relationships, the extended marketing mix and external environment are explored in this report. Marks & Spencer is compared with John Lewis & Partners prior to a strategic marketing and media plan being developed.

# LO1: Explain the Role of Marketing and How It Interrelates with Other Business Units

## P1: Explain the Concept of Marketing and Marketing Operations

Marketing involves recognising customers' needs, designing a value, and communicating it to customers and building customer relationships with a profit (Haris, 2024). It is broader than advertising in that it relates demand to products, prices, distribution and customer service.

**Marketing Operations at Marks & Spencer**

Marketing operations comprise marketing research, customer analysis, segmentation, branding, pricing support and campaign management. Digital marketing brings in traffic to websites and mobile devices, and CRM efforts retain customers based on buying information and feedback (Ryan, 2021). Marketing metrics and sales analysis determine if marketing efforts are succeeding in producing sales and engagement.

**Application to GreenLife Living**

The attitude toward sustainable products and attitudes towards sustainable packaging, sustainable price, and sustainable environmental claims; research would estimate demand for sustainable products (Seo et al., 2016). There is a need for segmentation that could differentiate the committed ethical consumers from customers who are more interested in achieving value. Marketing would encourage the use of the AI assistant and the delivery of items, which would also be carbon-neutral, and measure app usage, sales and repeat purchases (Kozik-Kołodziej, 2026). Accurate communication would also keep Marks & Spencer from running into trouble for greenwashing.

## P2: Explain How Marketing Relates to the Wider Organisational Context

Financed campaign, backs price, and measures ROI. Human Resources hires and educates staff to teach about sustainable products (Denga, Vajjhala and Rakshit, 2022). Digital Commerce manages the website, mobile application and AI assistant. It also offers traffic information, engagement and conversion statistics.

Operations makes sure the promoted products are on store shelves, and the store displays comply with the campaign. Supply Chain coordinates the development of supply chains that ensure

responsible sourcing, stock and carbon-neutral delivery capacity. No claims are going to be published without a review from Sustainability Management in relation to the environment. Customer Service writes down customers' complaints in some aspect about products and delivery, prices, and the mobile application and forwards them to marketing.

These relationships result in an ongoing information flow and operational support. When demand is stimulated by Marketing, the rest of the organisation has to deliver the campaign promise. This involves planning GreenLife Living, and not only doing promotional work; this has to happen in a coordinated fashion.




*Figure 1: Interrelationship Between Marketing and Other Marks & Spencer Functions (Source: Author)*

## M1: Analyse the Role of Marketing in the Marketing Environment

### Sustainability and Economic Pressure

The awareness of sustainability generates the need for GreenLife Living. But price sensitivity is not to be thrown out with the greenwash. Customers could be swayed not to buy sustainable products if the price gap and degree of sustainability, especially on the customers' side, seem to be too high (Groucutt and Hopkins, 2015). As such, marketing need not be restricted to ethical statements but, rather, should convey durability, as well as quality and value.

### Digital Change and Competition

Mobile commerce uncovers potential for personalisation for recommendations. The AI assistant can enhance relevance and conversion by minimising the number of searches to perform (Dr Sushma Ahire, 2025). But it may harm trust if they make an incorrect recommendation. Personalisation should be clear and stay under user control.

This is made even more competitive by precision and value retailers. Marks & Spencer needs to be more credible than value brands and yet more graphically challenged than specialists, who are seen as too niche to reach the mainstream. With more serious attention now being paid to environmental claims, it is now necessary to have sourcing, packaging and delivery claims backed up with evidence (Ivypanda, 2020). Marketing, consequently, is a growth facilitator and a risk management resource for reputation.

## M2: Analyse the Significance of Interrelationships Between Marketing and Other Functions

### Operational Significance

Demand can be created using an influencer or by using digital marketing, but Operations will need to keep the products available. If it can't keep its shelves stocked or can't deliver in time, it will get dissatisfied despite successful promotion.

All environmental claims are subject to Validation by Sustainability Management. If carbon-neutral claims aren't supported, it could hurt the trust of the Marks & Spencer brand as a whole. Finance needs to check if recyclable packs, loyalty and lower-carbon delivery are worth it (Chen, 2025). Otherwise, the campaign can boost sales, but decrease profitability.

### Digital and Customer Significance

In Digital Commerce, the accuracy and security of the AI assistant should be guaranteed, and its usage should be straightforward. HR has to get the staff ready to help out with the campaign (Wirtz, 2021). Customer Service should alert when the same problem is occurring repeatedly, for marketing message and process enhancement.

Lack of co-operation can result in confusion of prices, unobtainable products, unrealistic claims, or a failure of delivery. Marketing might coordinate the campaign, but essential to successful delivery of the campaign will be shared responsibility.

## D1: Critically Analyse the Internal and External Environment

*Table 1: PESTLE and Marketing Response*

| Factor | Opportunity | Threat | Marketing response |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Political** | Support for sustainable retail | Policy changes | Use adaptable campaign claims |
| **Economic** | Demand for durable value | Inflation and lower disposable income | Use bundles and Sparks rewards |
| **Social** | Growth in ethical consumption | Scepticism about green claims | Provide transparent evidence |
| **Technological** | AI personalisation | Privacy concerns and system errors | Use consent controls and human review |
| **Legal** | Stronger consumer protection | Penalties for misleading promotion | Verify environmental claims |
| **Environmental** | Demand for lower-impact products | Supply disruption and higher costs | Diversify sourcing and measure impact |

**Internal Capability**

Marks & Spencer gets their brand, customers' data, premises and online platforms. These are resources to help with scaling and personalisation (Jain et al., 2023). The complexity of the supply chain could render sustainability verification ineffective, and employee competence could vary across the stores.

**Critical Judgement**

Retail touchpoints and digital personalisation represent the best opportunity. The loss of clients' trust is the most serious. This means proper evidence of the environment and proper delivery rather than reaching people in the short term with the campaign.

# LO2: Compare Ways in Which Organisations Use the Marketing Mix to Achieve Business Objectives

## P3: Compare How Marks & Spencer and John Lewis Apply the Marketing Mix

*Table 2: Comparative 7Ps Analysis of Marks & Spencer and John Lewis & Partners*

| 7P | Marks & Spencer GreenLife Living | John Lewis & Partners | Comparative judgement |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Product** | Sustainable clothing, homeware, recyclable packaging and AI recommendations | Quality-led clothing and homeware supported by responsible retail activity | M&S offers stronger cross-category personalisation |
| **Price** | Mid-premium prices, bundles and Sparks rewards | Premium pricing linked to service and quality | M&S may attract more value-conscious customers |
| **Place** | Stores, website, app, click-and-collect and carbon-neutral delivery | Stores, website, app and collection services | Both provide strong omnichannel access |
| **Promotion** | Social media, influencers, email, events and AI recommendations | Brand storytelling, digital promotion and service-led messages | M&S may achieve stronger personalisation |
| **People** | Store employees, customer | Partner-led employee | John Lewis may hold a |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | service and digital support | model and service culture | service advantage |
| **Process** | AI-assisted discovery, QR codes and lower-carbon delivery | Established service and omnichannel processes | M&S offers more innovation but greater technical risk |
| **Physical evidence** | Recyclable packaging, labels, displays and digital badges | Premium stores, packaging and recognised visual presentation | John Lewis may communicate premium quality more consistently |

**Product and Price**

When it comes to placements, the products that GreenLife Living has developed are all sustainable, with support from the artificial intelligence used, while John Lewis is more focused on quality, design and service (Jobber and Chadwick, 2019). As long as the recommendations are correct, Marks & Spencer could have an innovation benefit.

If there are rewards and bundles, the cost of sustainable purchases may be lessened. By service and quality, John Lewis can justify premium prices. But there's a problem in both retailers: Shoppers who value sustainability don't want to pay huge price premiums.

**Place, Promotion and Service**

Stores and digital channels are used by both organisations. GreenLife Living makes carbon-neutral delivery part of its campaign. Marks & Spencer's promotion is data-driven, whereas John Lewis. It is more based on trusted service content and storytelling.

**Overall Comparison**

This means scale, accessibility and personalisation from Marks & Spencer. John Lewis provides more tangible proof of service and higher quality physical cues of premium. It is a question of whether M&S can achieve innovation without compromising brand trust and confidence in the brand's service or not.

## M3: Review Strategies and Tactical Approaches

### Marks & Spencer

A sustainability differentiation, personalisation and Sparks loyalty strategy underpins the proposal. These strategies include app suggestions, partnerships with influencers, sustainability occasions, e-mail deals, beginner deals, QR codes, and merchandising for carbon-neutral shipping.

Recommendations of apps can help boost conversions, and bundles can help lift average order value (Mr.C.Sasthi Kumar and Dr.M.M.Karthikeyan, 2025). Events and influencers can be used to increase awareness, and Sparks rewards can help with repeat purchasing.

### John Lewis & Partners

John Lewis aims to retail responsibly with their quality, service and positioning of homeware. This is reinforced through seasonal campaigns, product storytelling, all good ways to do loyalty communications, in-store demos and digital advertising.

### Strategic Review

Marks & Spencer is all about innovation and scale. At John Lewis, the priority is on consistency of service and premium value. Both are linked to larger goals, and their path to customer loyalty is different.

## D2: Evaluate the Strategies and Tactical Approaches

ROI, conversion, customer acquisition cost, retention, satisfaction, average order value and app engagement rate should be used to measure effectiveness (Kagan, 2021).

### Proposed Performance Targets

Suitable planning targets include:

- conversion rising from 3% to 4%;
- repeat sustainable purchases increasing by 10%;
- customer retention increasing by 5%;
- satisfaction exceeding 80%;
- campaign ROI exceeding 150%.

## Critical Evaluation

Marks & Spencer could enjoy an edge as the AI assistant can tailor sustainable decisions and decrease hunt effort. It also has its food, clothing, and home customers to create cross-selling opportunities. But digital personalisation can also exclude less confident customers and pose reputation risk when recommendations are poor. The campaign can also be unsuccessful if sustainable products are more expensive than the regular product.

Less advanced personalisation but more service credibility from John Lewis. However, it helps pay for the premium environment, and affordances can be a limiting factor (Jiang and Benbasat, 2017).

In total, Marks & Spencer offers greater scale and measurable digital interaction, and John Lewis offers more consistent service and physical authenticity. GreenLife Living can only be successful when price, evidence and convenience all work in harmony.

# LO3: Produce a Marketing Plan That Meets Marketing Objectives

## P4: Develop a Marketing Plan with the Key Planning Elements

### Campaign Purpose and Mission

GreenLife Living is all about simple, credible and convenient sustainable purchasing. The campaign itself is a mix of sustainable clothes, sustainable home products, and sustainable packaging; they are recyclable and sustainable, and delivery will be carbon-free and an AI-powered shopping assistant (Dube and Dube, 2023). It helps customers in the UK to choose things that are easier on the land while maintaining quality, value and convenience.

The campaign is aligned with the overall objective of Marks & Spencer's business, which aims to boost sales of sustainable items, enhance customer loyalty, and build a positive brand image. It also has a mobile application and the Sparks loyalty programme to encourage digital growth.

### Situational Analysis

*Table 3: GreenLife Living SWOT Analysis*

| Strengths | Weaknesses |
|---|---|
| **Strong UK brand recognition** | Premium price perception |
| **Large store and digital network** | Complex supply chain |
| **Existing Sparks customer data** | High sustainable-delivery costs |
| **Clothing and home product range** | Risk of inconsistent environmental evidence |
| **Cross-selling potential** | Uneven employee knowledge |
| **Opportunities** | **Threats** |
| **Growth in sustainable consumption** | Aggressive competitor pricing |
| **AI-supported personalisation** | Pressure on household spending |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Increased mobile shopping** | Greenwashing criticism |
| **Expansion of loyalty programmes** | Data privacy concerns |
| **Demand for transparent sourcing** | Supply-chain disruption |

As for the best combination, it is Online and Offline customers' information. This enables the campaign to be pushed to customers through multiple means of contact. But supply-chain complexity can undermine environmental evidence consistency.

The growing need for practical sustainable choices is the main opportunity. Economic pressure is the primary source of threat. Buyers are willing to pay green prices but dislike that big of an increase. Durable, of good quality, and value have to be stressed in the campaign and must also come across.

**SMART Marketing Objectives**

1. Increase GreenLife Living product sales by **12% within 12 months**.
2. Achieve **500,000 uses** of the AI shopping assistant within one year.
3. Increase repeat sustainable purchases among Sparks members by **10% within 12 months**.
4. Achieve a marketing return on investment of at least **150%**.
5. Improve recognition of Marks & Spencer as a sustainable retailer by **eight percentage points within one year**.

These objectives cover sales, digital adoption, loyalty, financial return and brand perception.

**Segmentation and Targeting**

Market segmentation on the basis of:

- **Demographic factors**: adults between the age range of 28-60 years with a middle or upper middle class income.

- **Geographic factors**: purchasers in key cities and suburbs in the UK.
- **Psychographic factors**: consumers who are environmentally friendly and quality aware.
- **Behavioural factors**: mobile shoppers, Sparks members and comparison data chasers.

The main target audience is UK adults aged 28-45, the digitally active working population and families. These customers are fond of quality and convenience and responsible consumption. The secondary market is customers between the ages of 46-60, who might be more interested in sustainable home products but need more information about the AI features (Al-Kenane et al., 2025).

*Table 4: Customer Profile*

| Profile area | Description |
|---|---|
| **Name** | Sustainable Urban Professional |
| **Age** | 35 |
| **Location** | Major UK city |
| **Income** | £35,000–£60,000 |
| **Behaviour** | Shops online and in-store, uses loyalty apps and compares sustainability claims |
| **Need** | Practical, attractive and reasonably priced sustainable products |
| **Barrier** | Concern about premium prices and greenwashing |

**Positioning and Competitive Strategy**

GreenLife Living will be positioned as:

GreenLife Living provides reassured sustainable products, available in smart and convenient ranges for those people in the UK who want to make a sustainable choice without compromising on quality, value or convenience.

The differentiation is intertwined with accessibility. Differentiation through AI personalisation, cross-category choice & carbon-neutral delivery. Extra accessibility through Sparks rewards and bundles and omnichannel (Kotler and Armstrong, 2016). But, in terms of range and data-driven personalisation, Marks & Spencer may enjoy a wider distribution and bigger data toolset, while John Lewis might have a winning brand for its superior service delivery.

## M4: Produce a Detailed Tactical Plan Integrating the Extended Marketing Mix

**Extended Marketing Mix Roadmap**

| 7P | Tactical activity | Responsible function | Timing | Expected result |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Product** | Launch sustainable clothing and home ranges with verified impact information | Product and Sustainability | Months 1–3 | Stronger credibility |
| **Price** | Use bundles and Sparks rewards | Marketing and Finance | Months 1–12 | Higher conversion and repeat purchase |
| **Place** | Sell through stores, website, app and click-and-collect | Digital Commerce and Operations | Months 1–12 | Wider access |
| **Promotion** | Use social media, influencers, email, podcasts, events and outdoor media | Marketing | Months 1–12 | Greater awareness |
| **People** | Train employees in sustainability claims and app support | HR and Customer Service | Before launch | Consistent service |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Process** | Add AI recommendations, QR codes and carbon-neutral delivery selection | Digital Commerce and Supply Chain | Months 1–6 | Lower customer effort |
| **Physical evidence** | Use recycled displays, clear labels, packaging and digital badges | Operations and Sustainability | Months 1–12 | Visible campaign proof |

Product details must have sourcing, materials, packaging and delivery choice. QR codes and digital badges can minimise doubt and justify the premium price.

Price strategies must avoid being too much of a discount since this can undermine quality. Better value without losing the mid-premium position is provided by Bundles and Sparks rewards.

Physical and digital retail should be incorporated in place decisions. The app should enable customers to identify products, view them at the store and shop via their favourite platform.

Promotion must be a combination of reach, education and conversion (McDonald and Wilson, 2016). Awareness can be built with the help of social media and influencers, whereas purchase might be stimulated through email and app notifications. Demonstrations and in-store events can strengthen credibility.

**Campaign Phases**

**Phase 1: Pre-launch**

Employee training, teaser materials, selection of influencers, AI testing and environmental claims verification are some of the activities.

**Phase 2: Launch**

The marketing involves national online advertising, in-store promotions, app promotion, outdoor advertising and initial offers.

**Phase 3: Engagement**

These activities comprise sustainable lifestyle challenges, user-generated content, podcast partnerships, personalised recommendations and Sparks rewards.

**Phase 4: Retention**

Retention activity comprises of individualised emails, product reminders, loyalty bonuses, repeat-buy offers, and customer polls.

The 7Ps, responsibility and timing are linked together through the phased structure. It minimises the risk of promotional demand surpassing inventory as well as personnel ability or IT capacity.

## D3: Produce a Strategic Marketing Plan with Performance Measures

### Performance Framework

*Table 5: Marketing Objectives and Performance Indicators*

| Objective | KPI | Proposed target | Monitoring method |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Increase sustainable sales** | Sales growth | 12% | Monthly dashboard |
| **Increase AI use** | Active uses | 500,000 | App analytics |
| **Improve repeat purchase** | Repeat purchase rate | 10% increase | Sparks data |
| **Improve campaign efficiency** | Marketing ROI | At least 150% | Finance and attribution |
| **Improve customer perception** | Brand perception score | Eight-point increase | Pre- and post-campaign survey |
| **Increase customer value** | Customer Lifetime Value | 8% increase | CRM analysis |
| **Improve satisfaction** | Satisfaction score | Above 80% | Customer surveys |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Increase carbon-neutral delivery** | Option uptake | 25% of eligible orders | Logistics data |

Reach, clicks, app use, and conversion will be monitored via weekly dashboards. Sales and expenditure will be compared to targets monthly. Satisfaction and brand perception will be measured with quarterly surveys. Additional analysis will be supported with social listening, A/B testing, competitor monitoring and customer feedback.

Weak performance must be followed with corrective action. The shift in spending can be out of low-conversion channels. Where there are restricted usages, app demonstrations can be reduced. Where conversion is below target, the prices or bundles might be revised. Poorly performing influencers should be replaced, while stock should move towards high-demand locations.

The strategy underpins the long-term expansion by enabling enhanced allegiance, enhanced client data and scalable personalisation (Patil, Rane and Rane, 2024). Through continuous measurement, there is diminished wastage of money as well as tightening of the competitive edge.

# LO4: Develop a Media Plan to Support the Marketing Campaign

## P5: Produce a Media Plan with Recommendations, Rationale and Budget

The media plan will focus on environmentally conscious and digitally savvy UK consumers. Its goals are to create awareness, grow usage of the app, create sustainable sales of products and improve retention.

*Table 6: GreenLife Living Media Plan*

| Channel | Main role | Content | KPI |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Instagram** | Awareness and engagement | Reels, product stories and sustainability tips | Reach and engagement |
| **TikTok** | Younger audience engagement | Short videos and creator content | Completion and shares |
| **YouTube** | Education and consideration | Product journeys and campaign films | Views and click-through rate |
| **Influencers** | Trust and social proof | Demonstrations and lifestyle content | Engagement and attributed sales |
| **Television and streaming** | National awareness | Brand campaign film | Reach and recall |
| **Podcasts** | Credibility and education | Sustainable lifestyle discussions | Listening completion |
| **Outdoor advertising** | Urban awareness | Posters with QR codes | Reach and QR scans |
| **Email** | Conversion and retention | Personalised offers | Open, click and purchase rates |
| **Mobile app** | Personalisation | AI recommendations and | Active users and |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | Sparks offers | conversion |
| **In-store media** | Physical reinforcement | Displays and demonstrations | Footfall and conversion |

A proposed academic budget of PS 2 million is employed since no specific amount is given in the brief.

| Media area | Allocation | Amount |
|---|---|---|
| **Social and digital advertising** | 25% | £500,000 |
| **Television and streaming** | 20% | £400,000 |
| **Influencer marketing** | 12% | £240,000 |
| **Outdoor advertising** | 12% | £240,000 |
| **Mobile app promotion** | 12% | £240,000 |
| **Events and in-store activity** | 9% | £180,000 |
| **Email, podcasts and content** | 5% | £100,000 |
| **Measurement and contingency** | 5% | £100,000 |
| **Total** | **100%** | **£2,000,000** |

Channels in the digital category get the highest allocation due to the possibility of precise targeting and measuring of conversion.

## M5: Devise an Integrated Multimedia Plan

The channels will accommodate a single connected customer experience.




*Figure 2: Integrated Customer Journey (Source: Author0*

The visual identity, campaign message and environmental evidence will be the same as used in all channels. Customers will be informed by outdoor media and social video and will be referred to the site or app. The AI assistant will help in product selection, and displays in the stores and trained employees will support digital claims.

Personalised emails and Sparks rewards will be informed by purchase data. Feedback from customers will be sent back to marketing and will enhance future communication (Huang and Shyu, 2019). It is an arrangement of creating awareness, consideration, purchase and retention instead of considering each media channel individually.

## D4: Justify the Integrated Multimedia Plan Using Quantitative and Qualitative Criteria

The metrics of performance will be reach, impressions, CPM, cost per click, conversion, customer acquisition cost, attributed sales, app usage and repeat purchases.

Social and mobile media provide accurate targeting and measurement. The advertisements can be altered easily if they are poor, minimising the money that goes to waste. Outdoor advertising and television offer broader visibility but less specific attribution. They still have a purpose in national awareness and credibility of campaigns (Theodorakopoulos, Theodoropoulou and Klavdianos, 2025). In-store media introduces tangible support and can decrease the uncertainties over sustainable merchandise.

Qualitative aspects are also crucial. The Marks and Spencer brand should be up to the influence, and the claims made by the influencers have to be truthful regarding the environment. Mismatch can be harmful to authenticity (Ngai, Tao and Moon, 2015). Email ensures low-cost retention, yet too much email can result in more unsubscribes. Less confident users also should have access to digital services.

The greatest strategy is thus one that integrates high-reach media, quantifiable digital communication and credible material attributes.

## Conclusion and Recommendations

Marketing relates customer requirements to product development, pricing, digital delivery and sustainability goals. GreenLife Living can be achieved due to the integration of retail scale, customer data, and omnichannel access of Marks and Spencer. It has better personalisation and increased accessibility relative to John Lewis, but John Lewis might have better service credibility.

The winning of campaigns necessitates confirmable environmental assertion, certifiable customer information and value packages and Sparks rewards. Online and offline channels are to be used as a single customer journey. Sales, Customer Lifetime Value, ROI, satisfaction and retention need to be tracked; spending and operational activity need to be varied where performance falls short of target.

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